

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	APSS3883		
Subject Title	Behavioural and Social Sciences I		
Credit Value	3		
Level	3		
Pre-requisite	Nil		
Assessment Method	100% Continuous Assessment	Individual Assessment	Group Assessment
	1. Class participation	5%	--
	2. One Seminar Group Presentation	--	20%
	3. One Written Integrative Project Group Report	--	20%
	4. Mini Assignment and Web-assisted Quizzes	25%	--
	5. Final Quiz	30%	--
	0% Examination	--	--
	The grade is calculated according to the percentage assigned		
Objectives	1. To familiarize students with the scientific methods used to investigate human development as well as the major theories of development and developmental concepts from across the lifespan. 2. To appreciate the interaction between internal and external factors in shaping human development. 3. To help students understand the connections between theory, research, and practice.		
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) Demonstrate good understanding of the nature, objectives, and scope of developmental psychology; b) Describe how developmental theories and concepts can be applied in evaluating and solving human problems related to a variety of issues, for examples, parenting, education, close relationships, and mental health.		

	c) Identify specific socio-cultural contexts (e.g., culture, society, ethnicity, religion, gender, etc.), the ways these influence human growth and development, and how socially responsible behaviors can be informed by these factors d) Apply major methodological techniques, both qualitative and quantitative, to study human development.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus (Note 2)	1. <u>Fundamental Approaches and Research Methods of Human Development</u> 1.1 Introduction and Key Issues: <i>Philosophical and Scientific Roots, Nature vs. Nurture, Continuous vs. Discontinuous, Lifespan Approaches vs. Focus On Particular Periods</i> 1.2 The Major Theories of Human Development: <i>Psychodynamic Perspective, Behavioral Perspective, Cognitive Perspective, Humanistic Perspective, Evolutionary Perspective, Bioecological Approach</i> 1.3 Developmental Diversity and Life-History Trade- off: <i>Ecological, Cultural, Racial, Social and Individual</i> 1.4 Qualitative and Quantitative Research Methods in Developmental Psychology: <i>Cross-sectional, Longitudinal, Sequential Designs and others</i> 2. <u>Genetics, Prenatal Development, and Birth</u> 2.1 Pre-birth and Foundations of Genetics: <i>Establishing the Sex, Transmission of Genetic Information, Inherited and Genetic Disorders</i> 2.2 The Interaction of Heredity and Environment: <i>The Role of the Environment in Determining the Expression of Genes, The Role of Genes in Creating Environment</i> 2.3 Prenatal Growth: <i>Stages, Threats, Being a Mother</i> 2.4 Giving Birth: <i>The Process, Problematic Birth and Mortality</i> 3. <u>Physical Growth and Aging Across the Life Span</u> 3.1 Stages and Changes in Physical Growth: <i>Life Cycles of Infancy, Changes in Body Shape, Height, and Weight From Childhood to Adulthood, Aging</i> 3.2 Motor Development: <i>Gross Motor Skills, Fine Motor Skills, Norms and Diversity</i>

	3.3 Brain Development: <i>Synaptic Pruning, Reflexes and Lateralization, Environmental Influences, The Link Between Brain Growth and Cognitive Development</i> 3.4 Perceptual Development: <i>Sensory through Lifespan, Habitualization in Infants</i> 3.5 Death and Grieving: <i>The End of Life: Causes of and Reactions to Death and Dying, Kubler-Ross' Theory in Process of Dying, Individual and Cultural Differences of Grief and Bereavement</i> 4. <u>Cognitive Growth: Piaget and Vygotsky</u> 4.1 Piaget's Approach: <i>Sensorimotor Stage, Preoperational Stage, Concrete Operational Stage, Formal Operational Stage, Other Approaches to Postformal Thought</i> 4.2 Vygotsky's View: <i>The Zone of Proximal Development, The Role of Culture</i> 4.3 Development of Attention: <i>Lifespan Changes, Children's Planning and Control, Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder</i> 4.4 Development of Memory: <i>Lifespan Changes, Infant Amnesia, Children's Testimony, Autobiographical Memory, Dementia</i> 5. <u>Development of Intelligence</u> 5.1 Development of IQ: <i>Lifespan changes, IQ and School Achievement, Creativity, Individual and Gender Differences</i> 5.2 Mental Retardation, Gifted and Talented, Unsociable Brainiacs 5.3 Schooling Through Lifespan: <i>Kindergarten to High School, Lifelong Learning, Head Start</i> 5.4 Delayed Gratification and School Achievement 6. <u>Development of Language</u> 6.1 Development of Language: <i>Lifespan Course, Prelinguistic Communication, Timetable of Beginning to Talk, Language Acquisition</i> 6.2 Evolution of Language, from hand to mouth 6.3 Sensitive Period of Language Acquisition, Bilingualism 6.4 Learning to Read and Dyslexia
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	7. <u>Social and Emotional Development and The Development of Personality</u> 7.1 Early Social Relationships: <i>Strange Situation Paradigm and Attachment, Peer Interaction</i> 7.2 Attachment in Adulthood: <i>Intimate Relationship, Love</i> 7.3 Emotional Development: <i>Lifespan Changes, Empathy, Anxiety, Depression, Happiness,</i> 7.4 Personality Development Across the Life Span: <i>Temperament, Erikson's Theory of Psychosocial Development, Personality from Early Childhood to Late Adulthood, Midlife Crisis, Life Review and Reminiscence, Personality and the Interaction of Genetics and the Environment</i> 8. <u>Development of The Self and Gender</u> 8.1 Development of The Self: <i>The Roots of Self-Awareness, Development of Self-Identity, Defining the Self Through Life Events</i> 8.2 Evaluating the Self: <i>Self-Esteem in Different Stages</i> 8.3 Gender Identity: <i>Children's Understanding, Gender Differences and Similarity</i> 8.4 Sexual Maturation and Sexuality: <i>Body Image, Puberty, Sexual Relationship, Homosexuality</i> 9. <u>Peer Relationship and Family</u> 9.1 Theory of Mind and Play in Early Childhood 9.2 Friendship and Its Characteristics from Middle Childhood to Adulthood 9.3 Family: <i>Family Type, Modern Women, Family Ties in Middle and Late Adulthood</i> 9.4 Parenting: <i>The Role of Mother, The role of Father, Parent-Child Relationship, Sibling Relationship, The Role of Grandparents</i> 10. <u>Moral Development and Aggression</u> 10.1 Moral Development: <i>Piaget, Kohlberg, Gilligan's Work, Moral Cultivation</i> 10.2 Moral Reasoning and Moral Emotion: <i>Haidt's Work</i>
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	10.3 Values, Religion, and Spirituality: <i>From Childhood to Adulthood</i> 10.4 Aggression and Violence: <i>The Roots of Aggression, Aggression in School and Family</i> 11. <u>Brain models of language development and disorder</u> 11.1 Neurons and brain structure 11.2 Neuroimaging techniques: EEG, MEG, fMRI, NIRS and others 11.3 Neuroanatomy of language 11.4 Neural bases of language and reading disorder						
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	<table> <tr> <td>Face-to-face and Web-assisted Lectures</td><td>30 hours</td></tr> <tr> <td><u>Seminars (Tutorials)</u></td><td><u>9 hours</u></td></tr> <tr> <td>TOTAL</td><td>39 hours</td></tr> </table> To achieve Intended Learning Outcome a and c, both interactive mass lectures and web-assisted lecture notes are prepared by the subject coordinator, with some guest lectures to be delivered by psychologists with relevant expertise. The web-assisted learning and teaching activities are designed to encourage students' self-study after lectures. The subject lecturer is committed to strike a flexible balance of interactive activities through direct student-teacher contact, web-assisted self-assessment, in-class discussions, small-group reports, role-play and case illustrations. Multi-media materials are used to facilitate learning. To achieve Intended Learning Outcome b and d, research-based group seminars and web-assisted quizzes are arranged to enhance students' understanding of the developmental psychology knowledge acquired from the lectures, web-assisted deliverables and assigned readings. These methods are considered as both a supplement to lectures and a self-learning tool for reinforcing students' integration and internalization. Seminar/tutorial groups of about 3 to 4 students each should be formed at the beginning of a semester to facilitate preparation and teamwork for one research-based seminar group presentation and project report-writing. Consultation is provided by the subject lecturer and seminar instructors whenever necessary. The seminar/tutorial instructors give feedback to individual students and in groups during and after the seminars/tutorials. Prompt feedback can be provided for each student after taking the web-based assessment and practice quizzes.	Face-to-face and Web-assisted Lectures	30 hours	<u>Seminars (Tutorials)</u>	<u>9 hours</u>	TOTAL	39 hours
Face-to-face and Web-assisted Lectures	30 hours						
<u>Seminars (Tutorials)</u>	<u>9 hours</u>						
TOTAL	39 hours						

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes

(Note 4)

Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)			
		a	b	c	d
1. Class Participation	5 %	✓	✓	✓	
2. One Seminar Group Presentation	20 %	✓	✓	✓	✓
3. One Written Integrative Project Group Report	20 %	✓	✓	✓	✓
4. Mini Assignment and Web-assisted Quizzes	25 %	✓	✓	✓	✓
5. Final Quiz	30 %	✓	✓	✓	✓
Total	100 %				

The grade is calculated according to the percentage assigned. The completion and submission of all component assignments are required for passing the subject.

Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:

The assessment methods include both continuous assessment and a final quiz. Coursework is based on continuous assessment, which includes mini assignments, web-assisted quizzes, one research-based seminar group presentation and one written report.

Mini Assignments and Web-based Quizzes

Continuous assessment methods include mini assignments and web-assisted quizzes which should cover the subject syllabus and essential reading requirements. The practice and assessment quizzes are generally examined in the form of multiple choice, and/or short questions. The web-assisted interactive methods are used to assess students' learning at the recall, comprehension, analysis and application levels, that are adaptable for a wide range of course contents and learning outcomes.

	<u>Class Participation, Seminar Group Presentation and One Group Project Report</u> Students are expected to actively participate in classroom activities. They will form in groups and each group will work on a specific topic of developmental disability. They will search literature regarding developmental disabilities and empirical evidences of treatment methods, present a literature summary and discuss how to communicate with children with developmental disability. The coursework allows students to understand essential theoretical and empirical knowledge of developmental disabilities, reinforces them to apply and integrate the knowledge into their real-life practice in speech therapy. Individual effort will also be counted in grading the group performance. The students will be assessed according to: (1) the comprehensiveness and accuracy of contents; (2) the appropriate application of knowledge; and (3) clarity in both verbal presentation and written report. <u>Quiz</u> An close-book quiz will be set in the form of multiple-choice questions and fill-in-the-blank questions, for all students to demonstrate their level of advanced knowledge and assess the intended learning outcomes of this subject. The quiz and continuous assessment results will be evaluated and moderated through various means: (1) setting clear and specific assessment guidelines; (2) regular discussions among the subject lecturer and all seminar /tutorial instructors concerned; and (3) moderation by an internal moderator for this subject.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lecture	30 Hrs.
	▪ Seminar	9 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Preparation for Seminar Group Presentation and Writing an Integrative Project Group Report	30 Hrs.
	▪ Web-assisted Quizzes & Mini Assignments	28 Hrs.
	▪ Preparation for Quiz	30 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	127 Hrs.

Reading List and References	<u><i>Essential</i></u> Feldman, R. S. (2016). <i>Life span development: A topical approach</i> (3rd ed.). Upper Saddle River, NJ: Prentice Hall/Pearson. Newman, B.M., & Newman, P.R. (2017). <i>Development through life: A psychosocial approach</i> (13th ed.). Belmont, CA: Wadsworth/Cengage Learning <u><i>Supplementary</i></u> Bee, H., & Boyd, D. (2012). <i>The developing child</i> (13th ed.). Boston, MA: Allyn & Bacon. Bell, P., Staines, P., & Mitchell, J. (2001). <i>Evaluating, doing and writing research in psychology: A step-by-step guide for students</i>. London: SAGE Publications. Berger, K. S (2015). <i>The developing person through childhood and adolescence</i> (10th ed.). New York: Worth Publishers. Berk, L. E. (2012). <i>Child development</i>. Boston, MA: Allyn & Bacon/Pearson. Berk, L. E. (2017). <i>Exploring lifespan development</i> (4th ed.). Boston, MA: Pearson/Allyn and Bacon. Bjorklund, D. F., & Pellegrini, A. D. (2002). <i>The origins of human nature: Evolutionary developmental psychology</i>. Washington, D.C.: American Psychological Association. Bond, M. H. (Ed.). (2010). <i>The Oxford handbook of Chinese psychology</i>. New York: Oxford University Press. (HKPolyU call no. GN635.C5 O94 2010). Bornstein, M. H. (2019). <i>Handbook of parenting</i> (3rd ed.). New York: Psychology Press. Boyd, D., & Bee, H. (2015). <i>Life-span development</i> (7th ed.). Boston, MA: Pearson/Allyn and Bacon. Davies, D., & Troy, M. F. (2020). <i>Child Development: A Practitioner's Guide</i> (4th ed.). New York: The Guilford Press. Feng, X., Keenan, K., Hipwell, A. E., Henneberger, A. K., Rischall, M. S., Butch, J., Coyne, C., Boeldt, D., Hinze, A. K., & Babinski, D.E. (2009). Longitudinal associations between emotion regulation and depression in preadolescent girls: Moderation by the caregiving environment. <i>Developmental Psychology</i>, 45, 798-808. Greig, A., Taylor, J., & MacKay, T. (2013). <i>Doing research with children</i> (3rded.). London: SAGE Publications. Jackson, S., & Goossens, L. (2020). <i>Handbook of Adolescent Development</i>. New York: Psychology Press. Kuther, T. L. (2018). <i>Lifespan development in context: A topical approach</i>. London: SAGE Publications. Newman, B. M., & Newman, P. R. (2017). <i>Development through life: A psychosocial approach</i> (13th ed.). Belmont, CA: Wadsworth/Cengage Learning. Newman, B. M., & Newman, P. R. (2020). <i>Theories of Adolescent Development</i> (1st ed.). New York: Academic Press. Papalia, D.E., Olds, S.W., & Feldman, R.S. (2014). <i>Human development</i> (13th ed.). New York: McGraw-Hill Higher Education. (with CD-ROM). Santrock, J. W. (2017). <i>A topical approach to life-span development</i> (9th ed.). Boston: McGraw-Hill Higher Education.
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	Shaffer, D.R., & Kipp, K. (2010). <i>Developmental psychology: Childhood and adolescence</i> (8thed.). Belmont, CA: Wadsworth/Cengage Learning. Von Tetzchner, S. (2018). <i>Child and adolescent psychology: Typical and atypical development</i>. New York, NY: Routledge. Hickok, G., & Poeppel, D., (2007). The cortical organization of speech processing. <i>Nature Neuroscience</i>, 8, 393–402. Pugh, K. R., Mencl, W. E., Jenner, A. R., Katz, L., Frost, S. J., Lee, J. R., Shaywitz, S. E., Shaywitz, B. A. (2000). Functional neuroimaging studies of reading and reading disability (developmental dyslexia). <i>Mental Retardation and Developmental Disabilities Research Reviews</i>, 6(3), 207–213.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

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